

Nature of a Robin

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Nature of a Robin

by [Iriascend](#)

Summary

When someone is stubborn, it's usually a bad thing. It's annoying, and only ends in arguments. Usually. Not this time.

Notes

This is a gift for Nique in the 2024 JayTim exchange! Hope you like it :) My prompt of choice was "sleepy boys cuddling together. warm outfits, comfortable place, warm tones". Sorry that it isn't much, the fanfic writer curse got me 😊

Thank you to the lovely people who did a quick beta-read for me, [Dis](#) and [Queenie](#)

See the end of the work for [more notes](#)

Kings have honour, soldiers have bravery, and poets have heart.¹ Most vigilantes fall into at least one of these categories. But Robins... Robins are different.

All Robins really have is resolve. The kind of headstrong persistence, the single-minded drive that makes it high impossible to change their minds.

Over the years, Jason's learned that one could sooner divert a river from its course with their bare hands than make any of them reconsider something² – for better or worse. It makes them excellent paragons of virtue, standing their moral ground even against overwhelming adversity, but it also makes them exceptionally vulnerable to stubbornly digging their heels in in situations where they *really* shouldn't.

In Tim's case, though Jason can't say he's in the clear there either, it's usually the latter.

Jason pushes the door to the study open slowly and steadily, as quietly as he can knowing that Tim still hasn't gotten around to oiling the squeaky door hinges. Mercifully, they don't make a sound this time.

Still, Tim stirs in his sleep, mumbling something under his breath and shifting. His right hand rolls over the keyboard. The document open on the screen starts filling with a solid line of 'm's, complimenting the already three page-fulls of 'f's.

The blanket Jason had given him earlier, when he left five hours ago, is laying crumpled and forgotten on the floor. Tim *promised* to go to sleep soon, *swore* he only wanted to wrap up one last train of thought. If the two extra dirty mugs on the side of the keyboard are anything to go by, he hadn't even *tried* to keep those promises. Jason sighs in exasperation and picks the blanket up, folds it loosely and puts it down on the desk. He's got more pressing matters to attend to at the moment. Putting the blanket away can wait until after Tim stops having the spacebar embedded into his cheek.

For a moment, Jason considers waking him up. He'd have the chance to change into something more comfortable, have a sip of water and maybe even brush his teeth before getting ushered to the bed. But knowing Tim, he'd insist on staying up and finishing his report with that characteristic Robin persistence.

If it was for the greater good, maybe Jason would've been easier to convince. Maybe he'd see the need for Tim to stay up for the third day in a row if the papers he was studying were about a serial murder case or something similarly pressing.

But it's not. It's a university assignment that's not even due anytime soon, just one that Tim fixated on.

And so, Jason carefully scoops Tim into his arms and, with measured steps, carries him out of the workshop. Tim must truly be out cold, because despite his honed instincts and vigilante training, he doesn't even crack an eye open.

Deciding it's not worth the risk of having to argue with Tim if he wakes up and wants to go back to work, Jason steers straight toward the bedroom. Despite visiting Tim's place regularly, Jay's never been invited into his bedroom so it feels... It feels like he's intruding, inviting himself somewhere he's not supposed to be. For that reason, he tries to make this swift and leave as few traces of his presence as possible. Ideally, when Tim wakes up, he would be under the impression that he made it to the bed all on his own.

It doesn't go ideally the moment Tim's body touches the bedsheets. He groans, whining about the sudden loss of warmth and comfy pressure. His eyelids flutter, and he rouses slightly, looking like he's on the verge of waking up.

"Shh," Jason coos quietly, trying to salvage the situation and lull Tim back to sleep. "It's alright. Sleep."

For a moment, Jason thinks it worked. Tim looks at him with hazy eyes, then puts his cheek to the pillow with a murmur, eyelids slowly falling back down. But then Jay tries to pull his arms back, straighten up and slither away, and that's what ruins it all.

Tim's arm shoots up, its path clear as if it's a homing missile, by far too intentional compared to how idle the rest of him is. He grabs Jason by the sleeve of his shirt.

They both still for a moment. Jason is not entirely sure how to react. He's fairly certain that Tim is unconscious, acting on instinct while still fast asleep. It is a bit surprising that he only acts *now*, given the man hadn't moved at all while Jason carried him over, but who knows what exactly sets Tim's conditioning off. And with how tight his grip is, it may prove difficult to slip free from him without disturbing him up even further.

Then, before Jason can figure out what to do next, Tim cracks one eye open and stares him down with the kind of steel disappointment only a true Bat can achieve.

"What are you doing," he asks in a flat tone of dumbfounded annoyance. Mumbles, rather, but it's hard to tell if that's because he's still half-asleep, or because he can't be arsed to speak any clearer at the moment.

"Sorry," Jason whispers, still hoping Tim can be put to bed without making a fuss. "Didn't mean t'wake ya up." He only manages to nod toward the door and shrug to explain his intention while his mind prepares all the ways in which he can persuade Tim to forget about his work, coax him to stay in bed.

Tim follows the line of Jason's gesture with his single open eye, then looks Jason up and down critically. He takes note of the confused expression, the body language clearly showing he's on his way out. The jacket still on Jason's shoulders. His irritation wanes, morphing into a weak smile as his face softens. Then, to Jason's surprise, he yawns and closes his eye again. There's no arguing about being babied, no trying to get back to work, no misplaced fighting instincts. Not even anger about Jason going into his bedroom without asking. Tim simply goes back to sleep as if nothing happened. He doesn't let go of Jason's shirt, though, so Jay leans back slightly and attempts to gently wrangle Tim's fingers off the fabric.

All he accomplishes is that Tim tugs him further down, without speaking or even opening his eyes again.

“I’d like to catch some sleep myself, y’know,” Jason snarks when it becomes clear Tim has no intention of letting go of him.

“Then lay down, dumbass,” is Tim’s answer as he pulls on Jay’s shirt again. Jason stumbles forward, taken off guard. He braces against the bed with his arms, trying not to fall face-first onto his boyfriend. Tim must notice the change of weight on the bed despite not looking, because he shifts his body a little, moving away. It takes Jason a moment to realise he’s making room on the bed for him.

And Jason may be a little dense sometimes, but he can recognise an invitation when he sees one. Even when it’s unexpected, different from anything he’s assumed Tim would do. Even when they’ve only been seeing each other for a few weeks and he didn’t think he would be invited to stay over anytime soon. Even when he’s still got his boots and jacket on, expecting to only be a brief hitch in Tim’s night, in Tim’s life.

He wanted Tim to go to sleep, so why would he argue if this is what will make Tim sleep?

And yet, he hesitates.

Deep down, he knows this isn’t just a request to spend the night together; it’s an invitation to *stay*. An invitation to a shared future.

Jason surrenders, his heart fluttering in excitement. He lays down, making himself as comfortable as he can. Tim murmurs approvingly and slots himself against Jason’s side seamlessly, like he was made to fit there.

There is no point in trying to change Tim’s mind, anyway. All Robins are, whether by chance, conditioning or sheer coincidence, unwavering about the choices they make.

And love is, after all, a choice.

One that they’ve both made, apparently.



End Notes

"Kings have honour, soldiers have bravery, and poets have heart" is a quote from [Naethan Apollo](#). [\[▲\]](#)

"you could sooner divert a river from its course than deny my nature" is a quote from a post by [Tumblr user lucentgallivanter](#). [\[▲\]](#)

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